Adam Bawatneh

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Website | GitHub | LinkedIn

Research Interests

Social reasoning and Theory of Mind, mental-state representations, and how AI systems use social context.
Interested in exploring these questions across language and multimodal settings, including generative AI and agent systems.
Current work: social reasoning in simulated societies.

Education

University of Central Florida — Orlando, Florida
Ph.D. in Computer Science — Aug 2025 – May 2029 (expected); GPA: 4.00/4.00
University of Central Florida — Orlando, Florida
B.S. in Computer Science — Aug 2022 – May 2025; GPA: 4.00/4.00

Selected Publication

Adam Bawatneh[*], Sagar Sapkota, Amrit Singh Bedi, Santu Karmaker, and Mubarak Shah.
"OmniToM: Benchmarking Theory of Mind in LLMs via Explicit Belief Modeling."
NeurIPS 2026, Evaluations & Datasets Track. Project | Benchmark

Research Experience

Graduate Research Assistant, University of Central Florida — May 2026 – Present
Conduct AI research and contribute to government proposal development, including IARPA-focused proposals.
Undergraduate Teaching Assistant, University of Central Florida — May 2023 – May 2025
Led labs and mentored students in C, Python, and Java courses serving more than 1,500 students.

Selected Research Projects

OmniToM: Social Reasoning Evaluation for LLMs — Oct 2025 – Present

- Led development of a benchmark spanning 895 stories and coordinated quality review with 11 annotators across more than 1,100 hours.
- Tested commercial and open models via Azure OpenAI, Anthropic API, and Google Vertex AI.

CADS: Context-Aware Detection of Specialized Language — Summer 2026 – Present
Mentored Valerie Lopez during the summer REU; the project continues in the lab.

- Developed and evaluated an NLP pipeline that combines complementary text signals to identify specialized language.
- Evaluated transfer across domains and languages to assess where the approach generalizes.

BIAS-101: Demographic Bias in Video Action Recognition — Jan 2025 – Apr 2025
Screened 85,000+ videos, curated 2,000+ clips, and analyzed demographic representation in action recognition data.
DETECT: Real-Time Gaze and Facial-Signal Analysis — Aug 2024 – Apr 2025
Led a 6-member team to build and deploy a real-time gaze and facial-signal system. Project evaluation reported 80%+ gaze-tracking accuracy.

Academic Service

Conference reviewer: NeurIPS, AAAI, ACL, and WWW.

Technical Skills

Research: Social reasoning, Theory of Mind, research design, benchmarking, experimental analysis
AI: Natural language processing, machine learning, language models, model evaluation, responsible AI
Programming: Python, C/C++, Java, JavaScript, Go, SQL
Model Platforms: Azure OpenAI, Anthropic API, Google Vertex AI, Hugging Face
Cloud and HPC: Microsoft Azure, Google Cloud, NSF ACCESS
Tools: Git/GitHub, Linux, Docker, PostgreSQL, REST APIs, LaTeX